Chapter 40 — Shared ViewModel Scoping

> **Part V — Shared & Global State** · Complexity: **Standard** (≥25 interview questions)
>
> **Prerequisites:** Ch 6 (UI state/ViewModel), Ch 5 (Hilt), Ch 8 (process death/ SavedState), Ch 38 (shared cart — SSOT alternative), Ch 39 (global state), Ch 53 (navigation, previewed). This chapter covers the **in-memory, scope-bounded** way to share state between screens — the counterpart to Ch 38's durable SSOT.
>
> **Reference surface in StreamCart:** a multi-step **checkout wizard** (shipping → payment → review) sharing one form across steps, and an Activity-scoped ViewModel shared by fragments in a legacy flow.

40.1 Problem Definition and Real-World Context

Sometimes a few screens in a **flow** need to share transient state — a checkout wizard's form across steps, a multi-page onboarding, a master/detail pane — where the state is **ephemeral** (only meaningful during the flow) and **scoped** to that flow, not the whole app or a durable store. A **shared ViewModel** (one ViewModel instance scoped to the flow's container) is the right tool. Getting the **scope** wrong is a common source of bugs and leaks:

- **Wrong scope = not actually shared.** Each screen creating its *own* ViewModel (default screen scope) means the wizard's step 2 doesn't see step 1's data — the "shared" state isn't shared.
- **Too-broad scope = stale/leaked state.** Scoping a flow's ViewModel to the whole Activity means its state lingers after the flow ends (stale on re-entry) and holds memory longer than needed.
- **Confusing "shared" with "global/durable."** Using a shared ViewModel for the cart (Ch 38) or session (Ch 39) is wrong — those need an app-scoped **SSOT**, not an in-memory ViewModel that dies with its scope and doesn't survive process death (without SavedState) or sync across devices.
- **Lifecycle/leak pitfalls.** Holding an Activity/Fragment reference, or observing with the wrong lifecycle, leaks or crashes.

The architecture: understand **ViewModel scopes** (screen / nav-graph / Activity / Fragment), pick the **narrowest scope that spans the sharing group** (usually a **nav-graph-scoped** ViewModel for a flow), wire it with Hilt (`hiltViewModel` + `navGraphViewModels`), and — crucially — know **when to use a shared ViewModel vs an SSOT** (Ch 38/39). This chapter is about **scope selection** and the shared-VM-vs-SSOT decision.

Three practical use cases

1. **Checkout wizard (StreamCart).** Shipping → payment → review share one `CheckoutViewModel` scoped to the checkout **nav graph**; the form persists across steps and is released when the flow ends.
2. **Onboarding (all).** A multi-page onboarding sharing progress/answers across pages via a graph-scoped ViewModel.
3. **Master/detail (tablet/legacy).** List and detail fragments share an Activity-scoped ViewModel for the selected item in a two-pane layout.

Why this is architectural

Scope selection defines **which screens share a ViewModel instance**, the **lifetime** of that shared state (released at the right time, no leaks/staleness), and the **boundary** between ephemeral shared state (ViewModel) and durable shared state (SSOT) — properties that determine whether cross-screen flows work and clean up correctly.

40.2 Requirements Engineering

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement
F1	A group of screens in a flow share one ViewModel instance (shared state).
F2	The shared ViewModel is scoped to the flow (nav graph), not each screen.
F3	The shared state is released when the flow ends (no leak/staleness).
F4	Survive config change; optionally process death (SavedState, Ch 8).
F5	Choose shared ViewModel vs SSOT correctly per use case.
F6	Inject via Hilt with the correct `ViewModelStoreOwner`.

Non-functional requirements

Attribute	Policy
Correctness	Right scope → actually shared, released on time.
Memory	No over-broad scope / Activity/Fragment leaks.
Lifecycle	Survives config change; SavedState for process death (Ch 8).
Clarity	Clear shared-VM vs SSOT boundary.
Testability	ViewModel testable in isolation (Ch 6).

Scope

- **In scope:** `ViewModelStoreOwner`, ViewModel scopes (screen/nav-graph/Activity/ Fragment), Hilt `hiltViewModel` + `navGraphViewModels`, Compose Navigation shared VM, scope-selection decision, shared-VM-vs-SSOT, lifecycle/leak pitfalls, SavedState for shared VMs.
- **Out of scope:** UI state modeling (Ch 6), SSOT/durable shared state (Ch 38/39), navigation architecture (Ch 53), process death details (Ch 8).

Assumptions & constraints

- Jetpack Compose + Navigation (or Fragments for legacy), Hilt. A ViewModel is retained by its `ViewModelStoreOwner` and dies when that owner is permanently gone. `minSdk 24`.

40.3 System Design Fundamentals

- **`ViewModelStoreOwner` determines scope.** A ViewModel is created/retained by a `ViewModelStore`, owned by a `ViewModelStoreOwner` (an Activity, a Fragment, a Navigation **back-stack entry**, or a nav **graph**). **Who you ask for the ViewModel decides which instance you get** and how long it lives. Two screens that request a ViewModel from the **same** owner share the **same** instance; from different owners, different instances.
- **The scope ladder (pick the narrowest that spans the sharing group):**
  - **Screen/destination scope (default):** each destination gets its own ViewModel (`hiltViewModel()` in Compose) — *not shared*.
  - **Nav-graph scope:** a ViewModel scoped to a **navigation graph** (a nested graph for the flow) is shared by all destinations in that graph and released when the graph leaves the back stack — **the idiomatic choice for a wizard/flow**.
  - **Activity scope:** shared by everything in the Activity; lives as long as the Activity — good for master/detail, but **too broad** for a transient flow (lingers, memory).
  - **Fragment scope / parent-fragment:** legacy equivalent (child fragments share the parent's VM).
- **Narrowest-that-fits.** Choose the scope that **exactly spans** the screens that share — no broader. A checkout flow → **nav-graph-scoped** (released when checkout ends), not Activity-scoped (lingers). Over-scoping causes stale state on re-entry and extra memory; under-scoping means it isn't shared.
- **Hilt wiring.** `hiltViewModel()` uses the current destination's owner (screen scope). For a **graph-scoped** shared VM in Compose Navigation, get the back-stack entry of the graph (`navController.getBackStackEntry(graphRoute)`) and pass it as the `ViewModelStoreOwner` to `hiltViewModel(entry)`. In Fragments, `by activityViewModels()` / `by hiltNavGraphViewModels(graphId)`.
- **Shared ViewModel vs SSOT (the key decision).** A shared ViewModel holds **ephemeral, scope-bounded** state shared by a **tight group** of screens; it's **in-memory**, dies with its scope, and (without SavedState, Ch 8) is lost on process death. An **SSOT** (Ch 3/38) holds **durable, app-wide** state shared by *any* screen, survives process death, works offline, and syncs. Use a shared VM for a wizard's form; use an SSOT for the cart/session.
- **Process death + SavedState.** A shared ViewModel survives config change automatically, but **not process death** — use `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8) to restore critical shared-flow state (e.g., the checkout form).

Core insight: **a ViewModel is shared by whichever screens request it from the same `ViewModelStoreOwner`; scope it to the narrowest owner that spans the sharing group (a nav graph for a flow), and reach for a shared ViewModel only for ephemeral, scope-bounded state — durable/app-wide shared state belongs in an SSOT.**

40.4 High-Level Architecture



Components & ownership

- **Nav-graph back-stack entry** = the `ViewModelStoreOwner` for the shared `CheckoutViewModel` — all flow screens request from it.
- **Shared `CheckoutViewModel`** holds the flow's ephemeral state (the form); cleared when the graph leaves the back stack.

- **Per-screen VMs** (default scope) for screen-local state.
- **SSOT** (Ch 38/39) for durable/app-wide shared state the flow reads.

Direction: flow screens → same graph-scoped owner → one shared ViewModel → released when the flow ends.

40.5 Detailed Component Design



Scope	Owner	Shared by	Lifetime	Use for
Screen (default)	destination entry	—	that screen	screen-local state (Ch 6)
Nav-graph	graph back-stack entry	all screens in the graph	until graph popped	**flows/wizards**
Activity	Activity	all fragments/destinations	Activity lifetime	master/detail; too broad for flows
Fragment/parent	parent fragment	child fragments	parent lifetime	legacy fragment sharing

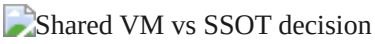
> **Graph scope is the sweet spot for flows:** it's shared across the flow's steps and **automatically cleared** when the flow's nested graph is popped — no manual cleanup, no lingering state.

40.6 End-to-End Data Flow

Graph-scoped shared ViewModel across a wizard



Shared VM vs SSOT decision



40.7 Complete Kotlin Implementation

Package: `com.streamcart.feature.checkout`.

40.7.1 Shared ViewModel (graph-scoped), with SavedState (Ch 8)

```
@HiltViewModel
class CheckoutViewModel @Inject constructor(
    private val saved: SavedStateHandle,            // survives process death (Ch 8)
    private val placeOrder: PlaceOrderUseCase,
) : ViewModel() {
    val form: StateFlow<CheckoutForm> = saved.getStateFlow("form", CheckoutForm())
    fun update(transform: (CheckoutForm) -> CheckoutForm) { saved["form"] =
transform(form.value) }
    fun submit() = viewModelScope.launch { /* place order (Ch 15/75) */ }
}
```

40.7.2 Compose Navigation: share one VM across the flow's graph

```
// Nested graph for checkout; all destinations share the graph-scoped CheckoutViewModel.
fun NavGraphBuilder.checkoutGraph(navController: NavController) {
    navigation(startDestination = "checkout/shipping", route = "checkout") {
        composable("checkout/shipping") { entry ->
            val vm = entry.sharedCheckoutViewModel(navController)    // graph-scoped (shared)
            ShippingScreen(vm, onNext = { navController.navigate("checkout/payment") })
        }
        composable("checkout/payment") { entry ->
            PaymentScreen(entry.sharedCheckoutViewModel(navController))
        }
        composable("checkout/review") { entry ->
            ReviewScreen(entry.sharedCheckoutViewModel(navController))
        }
    }
}

// Get the SAME ViewModel instance by scoping to the "checkout" graph's back-stack entry.
@Composable
private fun NavBackStackEntry.sharedCheckoutViewModel(navController: NavController):
CheckoutViewModel {
    val graphEntry = remember(this) { navController.getBackStackEntry("checkout") }
    return hiltViewModel(graphEntry)                // owner = graph entry -> shared across the
flow
}
```

40.7.3 Fragments (legacy): Activity- / nav-graph-scoped

```
// Activity-scoped shared VM (master/detail):
private val sharedVm: SelectionViewModel by activityViewModels()

// Nav-graph-scoped shared VM (flow) with Hilt:
private val checkoutVm: CheckoutViewModel by hiltNavGraphViewModels(R.id.checkout_graph)
```

40.7.4 When NOT to use a shared VM (use the SSOT)

```
// Cart is DURABLE + app-wide + offline + synced -> SSOT, NOT a shared ViewModel (Ch 38).
// class CartSharedViewModel : ViewModel() { val items = ... }   // WRONG for cart
@HiltViewModel
class CartViewModel @Inject constructor(repo: CartRepository) : ViewModel() {  // RIGHT: observe SSOT
    val uiState = repo.observeCart() /* ... */
}
```

40.7.5 Module structure

```
:feature:checkout  CheckoutViewModel (graph-scoped), checkoutGraph, sharedCheckoutViewModel
# Durable/app-wide shared state -> :data:* SSOT (Ch 38/39), not a shared VM.
```

40.8 Concurrency and Race Conditions

Scenario	Risk	Handling
Each screen creates its own VM	not shared	request from the same owner (graph entry)
VM scoped too broadly (Activity)	stale on re-entry / memory	scope to the flow's nav graph
VM holds Activity/Fragment ref	leak	never hold View/Context refs; use app context (Ch 5)
Process death mid-flow	lost shared state	`SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8)
Graph entry recomputed per recomposition	new owner/instance	`remember` the graph entry
Observing without lifecycle	leak/crash	`collectAsStateWithLifecycle` (Ch 6)

- **"Shared" is entirely about the `ViewModelStoreOwner`:** request the ViewModel from the **same** owner and you get the **same** instance; the whole bug class is requesting from the wrong owner (per-screen → not shared; Activity → too broad).
- **`remember` the graph back-stack entry** so you don't resolve a new owner each recomposition.

40.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

Failure	Detection	Response	Outcome
Step 2 doesn't see step 1's data	QA	scope VM to the graph, not per-screen	shared
Stale form on re-entering the flow	QA	graph-scoped (cleared on pop), not Activity	fresh each flow
Memory/leak after flow	LeakCanary (Ch 89)	narrow scope; no View refs	no leak
Lost form on process death	restart blank	`SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8)	restored
Using shared VM for cart/session	divergence/no offline	use SSOT (Ch 38/39)	correct
New VM instance each recomposition	state resets	`remember` graph entry	stable
Wrong owner in Compose	not shared/crash	pass the correct back-stack entry	shared


40.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

> **The two decisions that matter:** (1) shared ViewModel vs SSOT, and (2) which scope. Most "shared state" bugs are getting one of these wrong — using a VM for durable state, or scoping the VM too broadly/narrowly.

40.10 Scaling the Implementation

- **Level 1.** Default per-screen ViewModels (Ch 6) — no sharing needed.
- **Level 2.** A graph-scoped shared ViewModel for a wizard/flow; Activity-scoped for master/detail.
- **Level 3 — production.** `SavedStateHandle` for process-death survival of flow state; clear boundary between shared-VM (ephemeral) and SSOT (durable, Ch 38/39).
- **Level 4 — large.** Multiple nested graphs with their own shared VMs; reusable flow modules; consistent scoping conventions across teams.
- **Level 5 — enterprise.** Formalized flow/navigation architecture (Ch 53), scope-governance, instrumentation of VM lifetimes/leaks.

Avoid overengineering: most screens need no shared ViewModel. Use one only for a genuine multi-screen **flow**; for durable/app-wide sharing use an SSOT. Don't invent custom scopes when nav-graph/Activity scopes cover it.

40.11 Alternative Approaches and Trade-offs

Dimension	Option A	Option B	When
Shared state kind	Shared ViewModel (ephemeral, scoped)	SSOT (durable, app-wide, Ch 38/39)	VM for a flow's transient state; SSOT for cart/session/anything durable/synced
Scope	Nav-graph-scoped	Activity-scoped	Graph for a flow (released on pop); Activity for app-long shared (master/detail)
Process death	`SavedStateHandle`	in-memory only	SavedState for important flow data; in-memory for trivial/recomputable
Passing data	Shared VM	nav arguments	Shared VM for rich/mutable shared state; nav args for small immutable params
Composition	Compose Nav graph VM	Fragment `activityViewModels`	Compose Nav for Compose apps; fragment APIs for legacy

Shared ViewModel vs SSOT (the headline): a shared ViewModel is the right, lightweight tool for **ephemeral state shared by a tight group of screens in a flow** — it's scoped, auto-released, and config-change-safe. It is the **wrong** tool for durable, app-wide, offline, or synced state (cart, session, settings) — that belongs in an **SSOT** (Room/DataStore-backed repository, Ch 38/39) that any screen can observe and that survives process death and syncs. Ch 38 chose the SSOT for the cart *precisely because* a shared ViewModel can't give durability/offline/cross-device.

Nav-graph vs Activity scope: graph scope spans exactly the flow and is released when the flow's nested graph is popped (no stale state, less memory); Activity scope spans everything and lives as long as the Activity (fine for app-long shared state like a selected item in master/detail, but it lingers for a transient flow). **Pick the narrowest owner that spans the sharing group.**

Shared VM vs nav arguments: for passing a small immutable value between two screens, **navigation arguments** are simpler and stateless; for rich, mutable state edited across several screens (a form), a **shared ViewModel** is appropriate. Don't stuff large/mutable state into nav args.

40.12 Security Considerations

- **Shared ViewModels are in-memory** — don't hold secrets/tokens there (Keystore, Ch 20); a crash dump could expose them. Keep sensitive values in secure storage and reference by id.
- **SavedState is persisted to disk** (Ch 8) — never put secrets/PII in a shared VM's `SavedStateHandle`; save only non-sensitive flow state (and use idempotency keys for in-flight operations, Ch 15).
- **Scope = lifetime of sensitive flow state:** a payment form in a graph-scoped VM is **cleared when the flow ends** — good (don't leave card data in an Activity-scoped VM that lingers). Narrow scope limits exposure.
- **Clear on logout** (Ch 22): a flow in progress at logout should be abandoned and its VM cleared.
- Client vs backend: shared-VM state is client-side flow convenience; the backend authorizes the actual operation (checkout, Ch 75) regardless of client state.

40.13 Performance and Resource Optimization

- **Narrow scope = less retained memory:** a graph-scoped VM frees its state when the flow ends; an over-broad Activity scope retains it unnecessarily.
- **No per-screen duplication:** sharing one VM avoids recomputing/duplicating the flow state per step.
- **`remember` the graph entry** to avoid resolving the owner each recomposition.
- **`WhileSubscribed` / lifecycle-aware collection** (Ch 6) stops idle work.
- **Don't hold View/large objects** in the VM — leaks + memory.
- **Profiling:** VM lifetimes (created/cleared), memory retained by scope, LeakCanary (Ch 89) for over-retained VMs/Contexts.

40.14 Testing Strategy

The shared ViewModel is a normal ViewModel (test in isolation, Ch 6); scoping/sharing is verified with navigation/instrumentation tests.

```
// Unit: the shared ViewModel itself (Ch 6).
class CheckoutViewModelTest {
    @Test fun `accumulates form across updates`() = runTest {
        val vm = CheckoutViewModel(SavedStateHandle(), FakePlaceOrder())
        vm.update { it.copy(address = "1 St") }
        vm.update { it.copy(card = "4111") }
        val form = vm.form.first()
        assertEquals("1 St", form.address); assertEquals("4111", form.card)   // shared
accumulation
    }
    @Test fun `restores from SavedStateHandle (process death)`() = runTest {
        val vm = CheckoutViewModel(SavedStateHandle(mapOf("form" to CheckoutForm(address =
"A"))), FakePlaceOrder())
        assertEquals("A", vm.form.value.address)
    }
}

// Instrumentation (Compose Nav): assert step 2 sees step 1's data (same instance via graph
scope).
@Test fun checkout_flow_shares_viewmodel_across_steps() {
    // navigate shipping -> enter address -> payment -> assert address still present
}
```

What to test: the VM's logic (unit); that flow steps share one instance (navigation test); that the VM is **cleared** when the flow is popped (no leak); SavedState restore. A LeakCanary check that no VM/Context leaks after the flow.

40.15 Production Observability

- **Metrics:** flow-completion rate, VM-cleared-on-exit rate (should be ~100% for graph scope), memory retained by shared VMs, leak reports (Ch 89).
- **Logs:** `flow{name, step, shared_vm}` (no PII/secrets, Ch 28).
- **Debugging:** step 2 missing step 1 data → per-screen VM (not graph-scoped); stale form on re-entry → Activity-scoped (too broad); leaks → VM holding a View/ Context, or over-broad scope; blank form after backgrounding → no SavedState.
- **Privacy:** flow state may contain form input — don't log it; don't put secrets in SavedState.

40.16 System Design Interview Preparation

> ≥25 questions.

Fundamentals

1. *How is a ViewModel "shared"?* Multiple screens request it from the **same** `ViewModelStoreOwner` → same instance.
2. *What determines scope?* The `ViewModelStoreOwner` you request from (screen/ nav-graph/Activity/Fragment).
3. *Default scope?* Each destination/screen gets its own ViewModel (not shared).
4. *Idiomatic scope for a flow?* Nav-graph-scoped (shared across the flow, released on pop).
5. *Shared VM vs SSOT?* Ephemeral scope-bounded flow state vs durable app-wide state (Ch 38/39).

Scoping

6. *Nav-graph vs Activity scope?* Graph spans the flow (auto-released); Activity spans everything (lingers) — pick the narrowest that fits.
7. *Over-scoping problem?* Stale state on re-entry + extra memory.
8. *Under-scoping problem?* Not actually shared.
9. *Compose: how get a graph-scoped VM?* `hiltViewModel(navController.getBackStackEntry(graphRoute))`, `remember`ed.
10. *Fragments?* `by activityViewModels()` / `hiltNavGraphViewModels(graphId)`.

Lifecycle

11. *Survives config change?* Yes (ViewModel).
12. *Survives process death?* No — use `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8).
13. *When cleared?* When the owner (graph entry/Activity) is permanently gone.
14. `remember` *the graph entry — why?* Avoid resolving a new owner each recomposition.

Shared-VM vs SSOT

15. *Why not a shared VM for the cart?* Not durable/offline/synced; dies with scope (Ch 38).
16. *Why not a shared VM for session?* App-wide + durable → SSOT/holder (Ch 39).

17. *Good shared-VM use case?* A checkout wizard's form.

Passing data

18. *Shared VM vs nav args?* VM for rich/mutable shared state; nav args for small immutable params.

Security

19. *Secrets in a shared VM?* No (in-memory); Keystore (Ch 20).
20. *SavedState + secrets?* Never (disk); non-sensitive only (Ch 8).
21. *Narrow scope benefit?* Clears sensitive flow state when the flow ends.

Testing

22. *How test the shared VM?* As a normal ViewModel (unit, Ch 6).
23. *How test sharing?* Navigation/instrumentation: step 2 sees step 1's data.
24. *How verify no leak?* LeakCanary; VM cleared on exit.

Production debugging

25. *Step 2 missing data?* Per-screen VM, not graph-scoped.
26. *Stale form on re-entry?* Activity-scoped (too broad).
27. *Blank after backgrounding?* No SavedState.

Design-change challenges

1. **Wizard loses step 1 data on step 2.** Scope the VM to the checkout nav graph.
2. **Form stale when re-entering checkout.** Graph scope (not Activity) → cleared on pop.
3. **Form lost after process death.** `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8).
4. **Cart implemented as a shared VM.** Move to SSOT (Ch 38).
5. **Memory leak after a flow.** Narrow scope; remove View refs.

Mock walkthrough (abridged)

Clarify (ephemeral flow or durable/app-wide? which screens?) → shared VM vs SSOT → pick the narrowest owner (nav-graph for a flow) → Hilt wiring (`hiltViewModel(graph entry)` , `remember`) → SavedState for process death → security (no secrets, narrow scope) → testing (unit VM + nav test).

40.17 Practical Exercises

1. **Beginner.** Share one ViewModel across two Compose destinations via nav-graph scope; prove step 2 sees step 1's data. *Eval:* same instance; shared state.
2. **Intermediate.** Add `SavedStateHandle` so the shared flow state survives process death. *Eval:* restored after `Don't keep activities` (Ch 8).
3. **Advanced.** Compare scopes: show stale state with Activity scope vs fresh with graph scope on flow re-entry. *Eval:* graph-scoped clears on pop.
4. **Production debugging.** Fix a wizard using per-screen VMs (not shared) and a shared VM holding a Fragment reference (leak). *Eval:* graph-scoped; no leak.

5. **System design challenge.** Decide shared-VM vs SSOT for: a checkout form, the cart, the theme, and a master/detail selection — justify and implement each. *Eval:* form=graph VM, cart=SSOT (Ch 38), theme=SSOT/holder (Ch 39), selection=Activity VM.

(Solutions withheld unless requested.)

40.18 Chapter Summary & Reference Sheet

Key decisions: a ViewModel is **shared by whichever screens request it from the same** `ViewModelStoreOwner` — scope it to the **narrowest owner that spans the sharing group** (a **nav-graph-scoped** VM for a flow/wizard, Activity-scoped for app-long shared like master/detail), so it's shared **and auto-released** on exit; use `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8) for process-death survival of important flow state; `remember` the graph back-stack entry; and **reach for a shared ViewModel only for ephemeral, scope-bounded state — durable, app-wide, offline, or synced shared state belongs in an SSOT** (Ch 38/39), not a ViewModel. Keep **secrets out** of shared VMs/SavedState.

Concepts: `ViewModelStoreOwner`, ViewModel scopes (screen/nav-graph/Activity/ Fragment), narrowest-scope-that-fits, graph-scoped shared VM, shared-VM-vs-SSOT, SavedState for shared flows, nav args vs shared VM.

Common mistakes: per-screen VMs for a flow (not shared); Activity scope for a transient flow (stale/memory); using a shared VM for durable/app-wide state (should be SSOT); not `remember`ing the graph entry (new instance per recomposition); no SavedState (lost on process death); secrets in a shared VM/SavedState; holding View/Context refs (leak).

Checklist:

- ☐ shared VM vs SSOT decided
- ☐ narrowest owner that spans the group
- ☐ nav-graph scope for flows
- ☐ `hiltViewModel(graphEntry)` + `remember`
- ☐ SavedState for important flow state
- ☐ cleared on flow exit (no leak)
- ☐ no View/Context refs
- ☐ no secrets in VM/SavedState
- ☐ nav args for small immutable params.

Key APIs: `ViewModelStoreOwner`, `hiltViewModel(owner)`, `navController.getBackStackEntry(graphRoute)`, `navigation(route=...)` nested graph, `by activityViewModels()`, `hiltNavGraphViewModels(graphId)`, `SavedStateHandle` (Ch 8), `remember`.

References:

- ViewModel scopes / shared VM: https://developer.android.com/topic/libraries/architecture/viewmodel#sharing
- ViewModels in Compose Navigation: https://developer.android.com/develop/ui/compose/libraries#viewmodel

- Navigation graph-scoped ViewModels: https://developer.android.com/guide/navigation/navigation-programmatic#share_ui-related_data_between_destinations_with_viewmodel
- (composes) Ch 6 UI State, Ch 8 SavedState, Ch 38 Shared Cart (SSOT), Ch 39 Global State, Ch 53 Navigation

Chapter review (Phase 4)

- **Completeness:** all 18 sections; architecture/class/sequence/failure diagrams; graph-scoped shared VM + Compose/Fragment wiring + SavedState + anti-pattern; concurrency (owner determines sharing, remember entry); failure (not-shared/stale/ leak/process-death); 5 levels; shared-VM-vs-SSOT and graph-vs-Activity trade-offs; security (in-memory/SavedState/narrow scope); perf (scope=memory); unit + nav tests; observability (cleared-on-exit); 27 Q&A + 5 challenges. ✅
- **Expand later:** navigation architecture (Ch 53), SSOT (Ch 38/39), process death (Ch 8), checkout (Ch 75).
- **Interview coverage:** exceeds ≥25 bar.